



△ WOODED SHORELINE

Much of the shoreline of Lake Ladoga is covered in coniferous and deciduous trees. The conifers include pine and spruce, and deciduous species include willows and birches.

Lake Ladoga

The largest lake in Europe, with a huge drainage basin made up of thousands of smaller lakes and rivers



▷ AQUATIC BLOOM

The amphibious bistort, an aquatic plant in the knotweed family, is found in the shallows of Lake Ladoga and along the Neva River.



Located in northwestern Russia, near the border with southeastern Finland, Lake Ladoga is Europe's largest lake. Its total area is about 6,800 square miles (17,700 square km); from north to south it is 136 miles (219 km) long, and it is 86 miles (138 km) across at its widest point. The deepest part of the lake is near the tall, rocky cliffs of its northern shore, where it reaches 750 ft (230 m) deep just west of Valaam Island, one of the largest of more than 650 islands in the lake. The southern part of the lake is shallower and has a lower shoreline.

Lake and sea

Lake Ladoga formed in a graben, a depression between two fault lines, which has since been reshaped by glaciers. During the last ice age, it was part of the Baltic Ice Lake, which eventually formed the Baltic Sea when the ice retreated. Lake Ladoga is now separated from the Baltic Sea to the southwest by the Karelian Isthmus. The Neva, the only river that flows from the lake, leaves at its southwestern corner, passes through St. Petersburg, and drains into the Gulf of Finland (part of the Baltic Sea).

There are more than **50,000 lakes** and **3,500 rivers** in Lake Ladoga's drainage basin